Elm AI agents for responsible sourcing and supplier operations

Advait Raykar, founder of Elm AI

A fashion brand managing 600 factories worldwide.

Coordination and supplier communication never stop

Tariffs, quality, and supplier risk change the plan

Product still has to arrive on time for the season

Before a supplier can ship, multiple teams need to sign off.

A new supplier has to clear multiple internal approvals before sourcing can begin.

Every missing document, open issue, or unclear ownership slows down the sign-off path.

That is why the operational bottleneck shows up before product ever starts moving.

Responsible sourcing becomes the operational choke point.

"We cannot source this product until due diligence is done."

One factory issue becomes a business issue.

When teams are underwater, remediation gets pushed out.

The real bottleneck was the work after the data arrived.

- Audit reports and supplier records
- Dashboards, trackers, and spreadsheets
- Systems of record and document storage
- Reading audits and scoring risk
- Chasing suppliers for evidence and follow-up
- Routing issues, tracking deadlines, coordinating owners

The workflow still depended on people.

This is why Elm started with audit management and CAP tracking.

SMETA_Audit_203.pdf	PDF
Payroll_Notes.xlsx	XLSX
Worker_Interviews.pdf	PDF

$400-$800

consultant review

for a single audit

→

FINDING	ACTION	SEVERITY
Missing fire exits	CAP open	major
OT underpayment	CAP open	critical
Expired certificate	owner routed	minor

minutes

findings extracted

and actions opened early

That gave responsible-sourcing teams time back for remediation.

Elm takes audit management, CAP tracking, and follow-through off the team.

600
factories

~100
reviewed deeply

- Review backlog builds fast
- Scoring and CAPs stay manual
- Remediation gets squeezed out

100%
coverage

Critical issues surface early

Audits organized

Findings scored

CAPs drafted

Follow-up stays live

From finding to fix, the loop stays live.

Day 0

Audit processed

Findings extracted and mapped to the supplier record.

Minutes later

CAP drafted

The team starts from a working action plan.

Day 1

Supplier notified

Requests and evidence collection start immediately.

Day 14+

Follow-through stays live

Deadlines, reminders, and escalations keep moving.

From audit upload to corrective action in minutes.

From CAP to resolution with tracked follow-through.

Teams spend less time on paperwork and more time on remediation.

Even when teams are offline, the work keeps moving.

ACTIVITY

- **Audit review** 6:12
  Report in. Findings extracted.
- **Issue response** 6:18
  Critical issue routed.
- **Deadline tracking** 8:24
  Renewal loop started.
- **Performance** 11:07
  Score updated after closure.

OUTGOING REMINDER

To: compliance@factory.vn
From: notifications@elm-ai.com
Re: Action required: CAP due Apr 12

Your corrective action is due in 5 days. Please upload updated evidence to keep the factory in approved status.

View supplier status

suppliers ready | deadlines clean | issues moving | performance visible

This already works in the real world.

14+
customers today, up from 3 last year

5x+
revenue growth year over year

8,000+
factories on platform

3/5
top promotional goods companies work with Elm

Apparel

Stitch Fix, Reformation, Roots, Everlane

Promotional goods

3 of the top 5 companies.

The market is starting to pull.

100s

of companies have attended recent Elm webinars and events

Including many of the largest brands across apparel, sourcing, and consumer products.

Major brands are paying attention

Very few companies have production AI agents in this category

That is why Elm keeps getting pulled into the conversation

We can build this because we know this world.

Advait Raykar

AI systems, product.

Eesha Khanna

Sustainability, AI research.

Aparajita Thakker

Operator, repeat founder.

Our backgrounds span real-world AI systems, sustainability, supply chains, and operating programs inside major brands.

Built across NYC and Asia.

We have already helped scale these programs at major brands.

Our team and our technology have helped build from scratch and scale responsible-sourcing programs across more than a dozen brands.

Many of those brands generate more than $1B in revenue.

We understand both the day-to-day workflow pain and what enterprise deployment actually requires.

That is why Elm can start with one workflow and expand with credibility.

That same system can extend beyond responsible sourcing.

- Audit reports
- Supplier email
- Deadlines

SUPPLIER STATUS ISSUES DEADLINES

SUPPLIER
Minh Phat Textiles

OWNER
Responsible sourcing

STATUS
Active with blockers

NEXT ACTION
CAP due Apr 12

Status, documents, owners, issues, and history stay together.

→ Review

→ Route owner

→ Follow through

Responsible sourcing **Supplier readiness** **Supplier operations**

The same loop can run supplier operations.

Quality holds, chargebacks, shipping dates, and vendor scorecards all run through the same system.

The supplier record stays live, the right owner gets pulled in, and the workflow keeps moving.

QUALITY

Inspection failed HOLD

Factory owner notified. Re-check scheduled. Shipment stays blocked until clear.

CHARGEBACKS

Late shipment fee OPEN

Reason captured. Evidence requested. Recovery owner assigned.

SHIPPING

Port delay 2 DAYS

Delivery dates updated. Teams alerted. Next milestone moved.

VENDOR SCORECARD

Performance, responsiveness, and risk update as the work moves.

When the stakes go up, Elm already knows what to do.

CRITICAL ISSUE

Fire-safety certificate expired

Minh Phat Textiles has open orders and a blocked approval path.

EXPOSURE

- Supplier and factory
- Orders and sourcing activity
- Internal owners
- Current urgency

RESPONSE

- Notify owners
- Open remediation
- Flag exposed work
- Track to clear

The system knows where it came from and what it touches.

Responsible sourcing is where Elm starts, not where it ends.

Responsible sourcing

audit management + CAPs

issue follow-up

Supplier operations

supplier status

blockers and follow-through

Replace the legacy stack

supplier relationship

payment and coordination

The same shared supplier record is what lets Elm expand across the supplier relationship.

That expansion runs on one live supplier record.

SUPPLIER ISSUES DOCUMENTS DEADLINES PERFORMANCE HISTORY

SUPPLIER
Minh Phat Textiles

STATUS
Active with blockers

OWNER
Responsible sourcing

NEXT DEADLINE
CAP due Apr 12

OPEN ISSUES	DOCUMENTS	RISK SCORE
3	18	72

LIVE ISSUES

Missing fire exits	MAJOR
OT underpayment	CRITICAL
Certificate renewal	DUE SOON

Once the record exists, you can deploy an army of supply-chain agents.

Audit review and CAPs

Certificate renewals

Supplier readiness

Always-on supply-chain agents

Running 24/7 on the shared supplier record to keep goals, deadlines, follow-through, and performance moving.

Milestones and delays

Scorecards and risk

Payment and coordination

Elm is rebuilding the supply chain management stack for an agent-first world.

It starts in responsible sourcing, expands across supplier operations, and aims to replace the fragmented legacy stack around supplier execution.

Questions